Module 6, Lesson 6.1: Agent-as-a-Service Model

Turning Skills Into Income

You've learned to build AI automation systems. You've set up agents, created workflows, and automated tasks. Now it's time to turn those skills into income.

The Agent-as-a-Service (AaaS) model is one of the most accessible zero-cost business models. You build and maintain AI agents for clients who need automation but don't have the skills or time to do it themselves.

What Is Agent-as-a-Service?

The Core Concept

Clients pay you to:

- Set up AI agents tailored to their needs
- Configure workflows that automate their tasks
- Maintain and optimize the systems over time
- Train them on how to use the automation

You're not selling software—you're selling the implementation and ongoing support of automation that saves them time and money.

Why This Works

For Clients:

- They get automation without the learning curve
- They save time immediately

- They don't need to understand the technology
- They have a human to turn to for support

For You:

- Zero cost to start (you already have the skills)
- Recurring revenue from maintenance
- High value relative to your time investment
- Builds long-term client relationships

Services You Can Offer

Tier 1: Basic Agent Setup ($500-$1,500)

What You Provide:

- Single agent configuration
- Basic workflow automation (email, calendar, tasks)
- Initial memory configuration
- Documentation and training
- 30-day support

Ideal For:

- Solopreneurs
- Freelancers
- Small business owners
- Professionals with simple automation needs

Time Investment: 5-10 hours setup + support

Tier 2: Multi-Agent System ($2,000-$5,000)

What You Provide:

- 2-4 specialized agents

- Multi-agent coordination
- Advanced workflows (research, content, operations)
- Integration with their existing tools
- Training for their team
- 90-day support

Ideal For:

- Growing small businesses
- Content creators
- Agencies
- Teams with diverse needs

Time Investment: 15-30 hours setup + support

Tier 3: Enterprise Automation ($5,000-$15,000+)

What You Provide:

- Full multi-agent ecosystem
- Custom integrations
- Complex workflow design
- Team training and documentation
- Ongoing optimization
- Priority support retainer

Ideal For:

- Established businesses
- Companies with complex operations
- Organizations ready to scale
- Businesses with multiple departments

Time Investment: 40+ hours setup + ongoing retainer

Ongoing Services (Monthly Retainer)

What You Provide:

- System monitoring and maintenance
- Workflow optimization
- New automation development
- Troubleshooting and support
- Monthly strategy sessions

Pricing: 500−2,000/month depending on complexity

Finding Clients

Your Ideal Client

Look for clients who:

- Are overwhelmed with repetitive tasks
- Understand the value of automation
- Have budget for professional services
- Are willing to invest in systems
- Value their time

Red Flags (Clients to Avoid)

- Want everything for free
- Don’t understand the value proposition
- Aren’t willing to invest time in setup
- Expect overnight transformation
- Have unrealistic expectations

Where to Find Clients

Warm Network: Start with people you know:

- Former colleagues
- Professional connections
- Friends with businesses
- Local business owners

Content Marketing: Demonstrate your expertise:

- Write about automation
- Share case studies (anonymized)
- Create helpful content
- Answer questions in communities

Referrals: Your best source of clients:

- Ask satisfied clients for referrals
- Offer referral bonuses
- Make referrals easy

Communities: Where your clients hang out:

- Small business groups
- Entrepreneur communities
- Professional associations
- Online forums

The Oliver Agency Connection

When clients need more than just AI automation—when they need comprehensive digital transformation, marketing strategy, or full-scale business consulting—The Oliver Agency can step in. You focus on the automation layer; The Oliver Agency handles the bigger picture. It's a natural partnership that serves clients at every stage of their journey.

The Sales Process

Initial Conversation

Goal: Understand their needs and qualify the lead.

Questions to Ask:

- “What tasks take up most of your time?”
- “What would you do with an extra 10 hours per week?”
- “What have you tried to automate before?”
- “What’s holding you back from automating now?”

Listen for:

- Specific pain points
- Time-related frustrations
- Growth limitations
- Budget signals

Discovery Session

Goal: Deeply understand their workflows and opportunities.

Process:

1. Walk through their typical day
2. Identify time-consuming tasks
3. Note repetitive processes
4. Assess their tech comfort
5. Document opportunities

Output:

- Clear understanding of their needs
- Identified automation opportunities

- Rough scope of work
- Preliminary pricing range

Proposal

Goal: Present a clear, compelling offer.

Structure:

1. **Current State:** What they're experiencing
2. **Proposed Solution:** What you'll implement
3. **Expected Outcomes:** Time and money saved
4. **Timeline:** When you'll deliver
5. **Investment:** What it costs
6. **Next Steps:** How to proceed

Tips:

- Keep it focused on outcomes, not features
- Be specific about what's included
- Show the ROI clearly
- Make the next step obvious

Closing

Goal: Get commitment and start the project.

Approach:

- Address any remaining questions
- Clarify the timeline and process
- Get clear agreement on scope
- Collect initial payment
- Schedule kickoff

Delivery Process

Week 1: Foundation

Activities:

- Set up their workspace
- Configure basic agent
- Implement core workflows
- Initial testing

Deliverable:

- Working basic system
- Initial training session

Week 2: Expansion

Activities:

- Add specialized agents
- Implement advanced workflows
- Connect their tools
- Extended testing

Deliverable:

- Expanded system
- Training documentation

Week 3: Optimization

Activities:

- Refine based on usage
- Optimize workflows
- Address edge cases

- Final documentation

Deliverable:

- Optimized system
- Complete documentation
- Handoff training

Week 4+: Support

Activities:

- Monitor performance
- Address issues
- Answer questions
- Make adjustments

Deliverable:

- Ongoing support
- Monthly optimization

Pricing Strategies

Value-Based Pricing

Price based on the value you create, not the time you spend.

Example:

- Client saves 10 hours/week
- Their time is worth $100/hour
- Weekly value: $1,000
- Monthly value: $4,000
- Annual value: $48,000

Even at $5,000 for setup, the ROI is clear.

Tiered Pricing

Offer options at different price points:

Tier	Setup	Monthly	Included
Starter	$997	$197	1 agent, basic workflows
Growth	$2,497	$497	3 agents, advanced workflows
Scale	$4,997	$997	Full system, priority support

This lets clients choose what fits their needs and budget.

Retainer Pricing

For ongoing relationships:

Level	Monthly	Included
Basic	$297	Monitoring, email support
Standard	$597	Monitoring, support, monthly optimization
Premium	$997	Monitoring, priority support, weekly optimization

Retainers create predictable revenue.

Scaling the Business

From Solo to System

As you grow:

Phase 1: Solo Practitioner

- You do everything
- 3-5 clients maximum

- Revenue: $3,000-$10,000/month

Phase 2: Productized Services

- Standardized offerings
- Documented processes
- Some delegation
- 5-10 clients
- Revenue: $10,000-$20,000/month

Phase 3: Team

- You focus on sales and strategy
- Team handles delivery
- 15-25 clients
- Revenue: $25,000-$50,000/month

Creating Systems

Document everything:

- Sales scripts and emails
- Discovery process templates
- Proposal templates
- Delivery checklists
- Training materials

When you can hand a document to someone and they can execute, you're ready to scale.

Building a Team

Roles to consider:

- Sales/Account Manager
- Implementation Specialist

- Support Technician
- Content Creator (for marketing)

Start with contractors, move to employees as revenue supports it.

Common Challenges and Solutions

Challenge: Clients Want Everything Now

Solution: Phase your delivery. Start with high-impact, quick wins. Build toward more complex automation. Manage expectations from the start.

Challenge: Scope Creep

Solution: Clear proposals with specific inclusions. Change order process for additions. Regular check-ins to confirm scope.

Challenge: Client Doesn’t Use the System

Solution: Focus on training and adoption. Build habits gradually. Start with one workflow, expand as they’re comfortable. Check in frequently.

Challenge: Technical Issues

Solution: Thorough testing before delivery. Clear documentation for troubleshooting. Responsive support retainer. Escalation path for complex issues.

Challenge: Pricing Pressure

Solution: Focus on value, not cost. Show ROI clearly. Don’t compete on price—compete on outcomes. Be willing to walk away from bad fits.

Getting Your First Client

The Fastest Path

1. **Identify someone in your network** who is overwhelmed
2. **Offer a free or low-cost pilot** in exchange for a case study
3. **Deliver exceptional results** that make them a raving fan
4. **Get a testimonial and referral**
5. **Repeat**

The Case Study Approach

Your first client is an investment in marketing:

- Offer discounted pricing
- Document everything
- Measure results
- Create a detailed case study
- Use it to attract paying clients

Building Credibility

If you don’t have clients yet:

- Document your own automation journey
- Share before/after metrics
- Create helpful content
- Offer free workshops or webinars
- Get certifications if relevant

Coming Up Next

In Lesson 6.2, we'll explore Digital Product Creation—how to package your AI automation knowledge into products that generate passive income.

Key Takeaways

1. **Agent-as-a-Service sells implementation, not software** - Clients pay for your expertise
2. **Tier your offerings** - Different clients need different levels
3. **Price based on value** - The ROI justifies the investment
4. **Start with your network** - Your first client is closer than you think
5. **Build systems to scale** - Document everything so you can delegate